

COMMUNITY ORGANIZER

Community organizer and highly committed professional with a broad background of providing leadership and services in non-profit and municipal communities, complemented with an extensive background in the practice of law. Experienced at analyzing and establishing long-term strategic plans, optimizing organizational efficiency, and setting and meeting business objectives, as well as organizational management.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

MANAGEMENT AND OPERATIONS SKILLS

- Led multiple non-profits, including management of board members, staff, and volunteers to achieve organizational and project goals.
- Assisted with the formation of numerous non-profit and for-profit entities, and worked with leadership to establish or update governance documents to reflect current needs.
- Served as Managing Member of a 5-attorney law firm, managing staff and day-to-day operations.
- Legal experience interpreting and applying laws and regulations, and drafting and negotiating a broad range of contracts and other legal documentation.
- Developed new programs including creation of guidelines and program materials, and oversight of program execution.
- Drafted plans, reports, press releases, meeting minutes, and newsletters.

FINANCIAL AND RECORDS MANAGEMENT

- Developed systems for tracking regulatory compliance, as well as managing and maintaining records, in connection with federal and state grants.
- Established programmatic and departmental procedures for financial management and tracking.
- Served as treasurer and financial manager for multiple organizations, with duties including setting and managing annual budgets and ensuring compliance with legal and reporting requirements.
- Wrote and managed numerous grant proposals to fund community projects and events.

COMMUNITY SUPPORT

- Facilitated community meetings and discussions with stakeholders to establish needs and objectives, and methods for meeting them.
- Founded and directed a team of community stakeholders in a project which established a community arts center.
- Led a coalition of more than 20 organizations to collectively advocate for the local arts and culture community, and coordinated with the leadership of those organizations to set goals for advancement of arts and culture.
- Legislative work including drafting state legislation to protect homeowners against predatory lenders, as well as advocacy for access to alternative forms of transportation, such as walking and public transit, at both the state and local level.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

City of Medford – CDBG & Grants Manager 2023-present

Managing all aspects of the annual CDBG allocation and other grant programs for the City, including coordinating and drafting annual plans and reports; developing written policies and procedures to ensure regulatory compliance; establishing financial and record tracking systems; oversight and monitoring of sub-grantees, consultants and contractors, and assisting with development of new programs to support housing, economic development, and transportation.

Combined Jewish Philanthropies – Grants Operations Manager 2022 to 2023

Coordinated and managed application procedures and interactions between applicants, grant review committees, and staff for a grant program committed to creating an equitable world that expands opportunities for women and girls.

Law Offices of Laurel H. Siegel, LLC – Managing Member April 2008 to 2022

Represented a broad array of real estate clients from commercial and residential developers to individual homebuyers, as well as major commercial lenders. Handled all aspects of commercial and residential real estate transactions, including sales and acquisitions, financing, zoning and due diligence review, leasing, and condominium conversions, as well as formation, modification, and termination of business entities, and sale and acquisition of businesses and business assets.

Siegel, Wagner & Swartz, LLC – Managing Member June 2006 to April 2008

Kotin, Crabtree & Strong, LLP – Associate Attorney May 2001 to June 2006

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

ArtsAlive Medford Foundation, Inc. – Board Member 2016 to 2026

City of Medford Charter Review Committee – Co-Chair 2022 to 2024

Arts Collaborative Medford, Inc. – Founder/President 2017 to 2024

CACHE in Medford, Inc. (Coalition for Arts Culture and a Healthy Economy)

President 2015 to 2022; Board Member 2012 to 2024

Circle the Square Festival Planning Committee Chair 2013 to 2019

Medford Chamber of Commerce – Board Member 2021 to 2024

City of Medford Commission on Parking Policy and Enforcement – Member 2020 to 2021

Medford Community Coalition, Inc. – Board Member/Treasurer 2016 to 2021

Medford Arts Council – Council Member/Treasurer 2014 to 2017

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

Massachusetts Bar Association

Property Law Section Council – Former Chair

Joint Foreclosure Legislative Task Force – Former Co-Chair

Real Estate Bar Association – Legislative Committee Member

Massachusetts Bar Foundation – Lifetime Fellow

EDUCATION

Indiana University School of Law, Bloomington, Indiana - Doctor of Jurisprudence

Boston University, Boston, Massachusetts - Bachelor of Arts - Psychology and Philosophy